

JACOB JAMESON

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HARVARD
UNIVERSITY

Education

Harvard University

Ph.D. Health Policy (Decision Sciences Track), 2022–2027 (expected)

University of Chicago

M.S. Computational Analysis and Public Policy, 2020–2022

Johns Hopkins School of Education

Teaching Certification, Secondary Mathematics and Computer Science, 2018–2019

University of California, Santa Cruz

B.A. Economics and Mathematics, 2015–2018

Research Interests

Health care operations, causal inference, machine learning, decision science

References

Soroush Saghaian (Chair)

Associate Professor of Operations,
Decision, and Information Technologies

Robert Smith School of Business

University of Maryland

saghaf@umd.edu

Robert S. Huckman

Albert J. Weatherhead III Professor of
Business Administration

Harvard Business School

Harvard University

rhuckman@hbs.edu

Sue Goldie

Roger Irving Lee Professor of Public Health

Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

Harvard University

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Zachary Ward

Assistant Professor of Health Decision Science

Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

Harvard University

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Job Market Paper

The Impact of Batching Advanced Imaging Tests in Emergency Departments

PREPRINT

Jameson, J. C., Saghaian, S., Huckman, R. S., Hodgson, N., & Baugh, J.

Invited for 2nd round revise-and-resubmit at Management Science

Using detailed electronic health record data of over 150,000 patient encounters from two major U.S. emergency departments (EDs), we examine practice variation across physicians to uncover the operational impact of discretionary batch ordering of imaging tests. We find that quasi-random assignment of a patient to an ED physician with a higher tendency to batch causally increases the patient's length of stay, time to disposition, and the number of imaging tests performed. Discretionary batching increases length of stay by approximately 76%, increases time to disposition by approximately 88%, increases imaging by 0.91 tests per encounter, and has no detectable effect on 72-hour returns requiring admission. Results suggest that discretionary batching may lead to clinical decision-making that introduces bottlenecks in patient flow. Conversely, standard practice, which preserves diagnostic flexibility by allowing information from initial tests to guide subsequent decisions, offers an “information gain” advantage over batch ordering: the information obtained from a prior test allows the elimination of the need to order some future tests. Put together, our findings indicate that discretionary batch ordering is not an efficient strategy for managing diagnostic imaging in emergency care, and interventions to reduce unnecessary batching may improve both operational performance and resource utilization.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation Retreatment for Recurrent Depression: A Large Real-World Multisite Cohort Study.
Acta Psychiatrica Scandinavica, 2026. [PAPER](#)
Lyndon, S., Gibbons, J. B., Straub, L., Sung, M., **Jameson, J. C.**, Hathaway, D. B., Mulcahy, D. H., Elliott, C., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Szmulewicz, A. G., Yang, J., Aldis, R., Wyss, R., Wang, P. S., & Siddiqi, S. H.
2. Sex Differences in Life-Course Suicide Rates by State Firearm Policy Environment.
American Journal of Preventive Medicine, 2025. [PAPER](#)
Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Abou Baker, N., Pollack, H. A., & Tung, E. L.
3. A National Study Among Diverse US Populations of Exposure to Prescription Medications with Evidence-Based Pharmacogenomic Information.
Clinical Pharmacology & Therapeutics, 2025. [PAPER](#)
Saulsberry, L., **Jameson, J. C.**, Gibbons, R. D., Dolan, M. E., Olopade, O. I., & O'Donnell, P. H.
4. Variation in Batch Ordering of Imaging Tests in the Emergency Department and the Impact on Care Delivery.
Health Services Research, 2025. [PAPER](#)
Jameson, J. C., Saghaian, S., Huckman, R. S., & Hodgson, N.
5. Genomic Heterogeneity and Ploidy Identify Patients with Intrinsic Resistance to PD-1 Blockade in Metastatic Melanoma.
Science Advances, 2024. [PAPER](#)
Tarantino, G., et al. (including **Jameson, J. C.**)
6. Male Gender Expressivity and Diagnosis and Treatment of Cardiovascular Disease Risks in Men.
JAMA Network Open, 2024. [PAPER](#)
Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Huang, E. S., Kronish, I. M., Lindau, S. T., Peek, M. E., Tung, E. L., & Pollack, H. A.
➤ *Selected media coverage:* [Daily Mail](#), [TCTMD](#), [WBBM Newsradio](#)
7. Associations of Adolescent School Social Networks, Gender Norms, and Adolescent-to-Young Adult Changes in Male Gender Expression with Young Adult Substance Use.
Journal of Adolescent Health, 2024. [PAPER](#)
Glasser, N. J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Tung, E. L., Lindau, S. T., & Pollack, H. A.
8. Does the Doctor-Patient Relationship Affect Enrollment in Clinical Research?
Academic Medicine, 2023. [PAPER](#)
Soo, J., **Jameson, J. C.**, Flores, A., Dubin, L., Perish, E., Afzal, A., Berry, G., DiMaggio, V., Krishnamoorthi, V. R., Porter, J., Tang, J., & Meltzer, D.

Research in Progress

9. Reinforcement Learning for Repetitive Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation Protocol Selection in Treatment-Resistant Depression: A Multiclinic Cohort Study
Invited revision at npj Digital Medicine
Gibbons, J. B., Leenaerts, N., Siddiqi, S. H., Murphy, S., Straub, L., Hathaway, D. B., Yang, J., Szmulewicz, A. G., Sung, M., Aldis, R., **Jameson, J. C.**, Wyss, R., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Elliott, C., Mulcahy, D. H., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P. S.

10. Effectiveness of Extreme Risk Protection Orders in Reducing Firearm Deaths.
Invited revision at NEJM Evidence
Jameson, J. C., Pollack, H. A., & Glasser, N. J.
11. Machine Learning to Personalize Psychotherapy Selection for Patients at Elevated Suicide Risk in a Large National Cohort
Under review
Jameson, J. C., Gibbons, J., Sung, M., Hathaway, D., Straub, L., Aldis, R., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P.
12. The Effect of Legalizing Online Sports Gambling on Population Mental Health.
Under review PREPRINT
Kavanagh, N. M., **Jameson, J. C.**, Pollack, H. A., & Glasser, N. J.
13. Bayesian Anchored Latent Learning for Estimating State Trajectories
Under review
Gibbons, J. B., Leenaerts, N., Mandavia, A. D., **Jameson, J. C.**, Liang, A., Hathaway, D. B., Yang, J., Gu, B., Marx, B. P., Siddiqi, S. H., Wood, R., Ruble, M., Lyndon, S., & Wang, P. S.
14. What Constitutes a Good Biomarker in Cancer Treatment: A Counterfactual Decision-Making Framework
In preparation
Jameson, J. C., Saghaian, S., Liu, D., Tarantino, G., & Gusev, S.
15. Optimizing Scarce Clinician Engagement in Partner Notification for Sexually Transmitted Infections
In preparation
Jameson, J. C., Saghaian, S., & Jónasson, J. O.

Research Funding

2024–present: National Research Service Award T32 Predoctoral Fellowship, National Institute of Mental Health (T32 MH125815), Brigham and Women’s Hospital
Comparative Effectiveness Research in Suicide Prevention; Trainee; PIs: Miguel Hernán, Matthew Nock, Philip Wang

2026: Novartis Fund Project Award, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2026: Novartis Fund Conference Award, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2026: Graduate Student Council Conference Grant, Harvard University

2024: Howard Raiffa Research Fund, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

2022: Howard Raiffa Research Fund, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health

Awards and Honors

2026: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School

2026: Dean’s Award for Excellence in Student Teaching, Harvard Kennedy School

2026: Selected Participant, IOE-ISyE-MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan. Winner of People’s Choice Award for Poster Presentation

2026: Finalist, Harvard GSAS Three Minute Thesis (3MT®) Competition

2026: Finalist, Lee B. Lusted Student Prize, Society for Medical Decision Making

	2025: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School
	2025: Finalist, INFORMS Health Applications Society Best Student Paper Competition
	2024: Dean’s Award for Excellence in Student Teaching, Harvard Kennedy School
	2024: Distinction in Student Teaching Award, Harvard Kennedy School
	2024: Educational Innovation Scholar, Center for Health Decision Science, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
	2023: Finalist, INFORMS Public Sector Operations Research Best Video Award
Invited Talks	2027: Department of Health Services Research, The University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center (forthcoming)
	2026: Department of Public Health Sciences, University of Rochester School of Medicine and Dentistry (forthcoming)
	2026: Harvard-wide Fellowship in Pediatric Health Services Research, Harvard Medical School (forthcoming)
	2024: Center for Suicide Research and Prevention, Mass General Brigham and Harvard University
Conference Presentations	2026: Decision Science Institute (forthcoming; invited); INFORMS Annual Meeting (forthcoming; invited); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (invited); POMS Annual Conference (contributed); IOE-ISyE-MS&E Rising Stars Workshop, University of Michigan (contributed); Harvard GSAS Three Minute Thesis Finals (contributed)
	2025: INFORMS Annual Meeting (two invited talks)
	2024: Society for Medical Decision Making Annual Meeting (contributed); INFORMS Annual Meeting (invited)
	2023: INFORMS Annual Meeting (invited); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (invited)
Teaching	Economics for Public Policy , Harvard Kennedy School Instructor of Record, PPIA Junior Summer Institute, 2024–2026 (3x)
	Math Camp for Incoming PhD Students , Harvard Kennedy School Instructor of Record, 2023–2026 (4x)
	Decision Science for Public Health , Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health Teaching Fellow, 2023–2026 (4x)
	Machine Learning and Big Data Analytics , Harvard Kennedy School Teaching Fellow, 2023–2025 (4x)
	Game Theory and Strategic Decisions , Harvard Kennedy School Teaching Fellow, 2023, 2024, 2026 (3x)
	Resources, Incentives, and Choices I: Markets and Market Failures , Harvard Kennedy School Teaching Fellow, 2022–2025 (4x)
	Data and Programming for Policymakers , Harvard Kennedy School Teaching Fellow, 2023 (1x)
	Data, Quantitative Methods, and Applications in Health Services Research , Center for Translational Science, University of Chicago Co-Instructor, 2021–2023 (3x)
	Coding Lab for Public Policy , Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago Instructor of Record, 2021 (1x)

	Machine Learning for Public Policy, Department of Computer Science, University of Chicago Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x) Mathematics for Data Analysis and Computer Science, Department of Computer Science, University of Chicago Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x) Introductory Finance, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago Teaching Assistant, 2020–2022 (3x) Data Analysis in R and Python, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago Teaching Assistant, 2022 (1x)
Professional Experience	VA Greater Los Angeles Healthcare System, Department of Veterans Affairs Research Statistician (Without Compensation appointment), 2026–present Aerospace Technical Services Health Policy Consultant, 2025–present Division of Pharmacoepidemiology and Pharmacoeconomics, Department of Medicine, Brigham and Women’s Hospital & Harvard Medical School Research Trainee, 2024–present Center for Health and the Social Sciences, University of Chicago Data Scientist, 2020–2022 Teach For America, Achievement First Amistad Academy 7th/8th Grade Mathematics Teacher, 2018–2020
Academic Service	<u>Leadership:</u> 2026–2027: Short Course Co-Chair, SMDM Annual Meeting 2026–2027: Co-organizer, Research in Progress Seminar, Harvard Center for Health Decision Science 2026: Organizing Team, <i>Teaching Statistics in the Age of Agentic AI</i>, Harvard Kennedy School Workshop 2024–2026: Peer Mentor, Harvard University Health Policy PhD Program 2022–2024: Student Liaison, Health Applications Society, INFORMS <u>Session chair:</u> 2025: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Atlanta, GA) 2024: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Seattle, WA; two sessions) 2023: INFORMS Annual Meeting (Phoenix, AZ); INFORMS Healthcare Conference (Toronto, ON) <u>Short courses and workshops:</u> 2026: Build Your Own RA (Research Agent): Introduction to Agentic Coding and Custom Research Workflows, SMDM Virtual Workshop (Instructor) 2024: An Introduction to Reproducible Programming and Project Management, SMDM Annual Meeting (Instructor) 2023: Transparent Programming: Important Habits for Reproducibility and Research Integrity, SMDM Annual Meeting (Instructor)

Peer review:

Journals: Psychiatry Research; Medical Decision Making; Journal of Public Health and Emergency

Conferences: Society for Medical Decision Making Annual Meeting; International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²)

Professional Memberships

Institute for Operations Research and the Management Sciences (INFORMS); Society for Medical Decision Making (SMDM)

Software Skills

R, Python, Stata, SQL; D3, Git, Docker, TreeAge

Additional Information

Hobbies and Interests

Birding, drumming, scary movies